Chromosomal evidence

A strong piece of evidence in favor of a shared common ancestor is seen by comparing chromosomes. Chimpanzees (and gorillas) have 24 pairs of chromosomes. Humans have only 23. Evolutionary scientists believe that when we diverged from a common ancestor, two chromosomes in humans fused and this is why we have one less pair than other apes.

On the ends of every chromosome, there are genetic markers—or sequences of DNA—called telomeres. In the middle of each chromosome there is a different sequence, known as a centromere. If two chromosomes have fused, it should be possible to see telomere-like regions in the middle of the chromosome as well as at each end. Also, the fused chromosome would have two centromeres. Scientists looked and found just this. Human chromosome 2 appears to be the fusion of chimp chromosomes 2a and 2b. It is almost beyond doubt that we share a common ancestor with chimps, bonobos, and gorillas.

Cooperative behavior

Another aspect of chimps' hunting behavior that is similar to that of humans is the social element. Although chimps sometimes hunt alone, hunting tends to be a group activity. Chimps rampage through the forest, coordinating their positions and surrounding their prey. After the hunt, the food is shared. This shows how early ancestors of humans may have developed cooperative behavior, a factor that may have contributed to their evolutionary success.